

The Dawn of the DevOps Decade

Trending in today's software development world is the DevOps culture. No more are monolith apps being developed with reams and reams of code. For the progressive developers of today, DevOps has become the way to work.



A dialogue often heard in tech companies that develop apps is: **Operations team member:** “Oh no, the server is going down! We need to roll back the updates they just sent us. Who writes this code anyway; don’t they test it beforehand?”

Development team member: “Hey, we wrote the code and the QA team tested it to confirm it works in both our environments. The problem is likely with your deployment process and not our code!”

You can well imagine this scenario recurring at any one of the thousands of tech companies building to-scale products that serve millions of users. The bigger the code base, the higher the likelihood of bugs and the more challenging the road from development to production. While unit-tests play a significant role in the process, it is evident that communication plays an equal or greater role, especially in resolving sensitive situations that can otherwise go awry for the entire team. In such cases, the adoption of the DevOps model becomes inevitable. Essentially, this is the team that bridges the developer-operations gap.

The purpose is to aid in shortening the systems and software development life cycle whilst continuing to deliver features, updates and bug fixes frequently and in close alignment with business objectives.

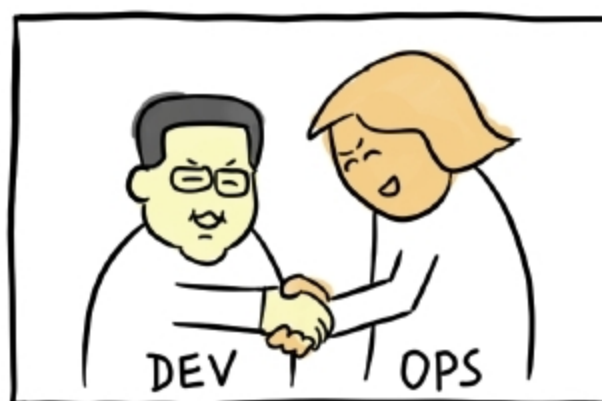
Why has DevOps become popular?

As the Amazon Web Services explanation goes, DevOps is the combination of cultural philosophies, practices and tools that increases an organisation’s ability to deliver applications and services at high velocity, evolving and improving products at a faster pace than organisations that use traditional software development and infrastructure management processes. According to Webopedia, the goal of DevOps is to change and improve the

relationship between the Dev team and the Ops team, by advocating better communication and collaboration between these two business units.

In some ways, DevOps started as the introduction of some much-needed sanity in navigating the quagmire of enterprise-scale software. The idea was to take products from being ‘in principle’ to ‘in practice’, dealing with hordes of issues and putting out all the fires that are lit along the way. DevOps deals with a mix of culture, practices and pipelines. It moves from traditional software development, followed by deployment and then blends both, hence ironing out the kinks that usually occur on account of communication lapses and, in general, entirely disparate processes.

For these reasons, DevOps now plays a growing role in many organisations. Adopting DevOps is usually well-compensated since it deals with a growing skillset and expertise in cross-domain topics. Typically, DevOps engineers are either professionals adept in systems and networking, and are inclined towards more of development; or they are software developers that are drifting



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Figure 1: Developers and operations staff must collaborate for DevOps